

Damien Foster

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Professional Summary

Network Engineer with 14+ years of progressive IT experience across enterprise networking, cloud operations, and infrastructure support. I have a Bachelor of Science in Network Operations and Security, along with nine industry certifications including CCNA and AWS Certified SysOps Administrator. Highly motivated and skilled in designing, implementing, and supporting large-scale, high-availability network environments. CCNP certificate is in progress.

Professional Experience

Bleckmann • Network Engineer • April 2026 - Present

- Spearheaded the design and deployment of a greenfield enterprise network for a 515,000 sq. ft. distribution center, delivering highly available LAN, WAN, wireless, and security infrastructure from initial design through production operations.
- Architected and implemented a fully redundant network utilizing dual Cato SD-WAN firewalls, HPE Aruba core and access switching, VSX core redundancy, VSF access-stack resiliency, Cross-Stack LAG, multiple fiber paths, and ISP failover.
- Designed and deployed the facility MDF and 10 IDFs, including racks, UPS systems, ATS units, managed PDUs, fiber distribution, patch panels, structured cabling, and network hardware installation.
- Deployed and configured 32 enterprise ExtremeNetworks wireless access points providing complete warehouse and office coverage for operational, administrative, and mobile workforce requirements.
- Partnered with vendors, contractors, and internal stakeholders to deliver network, wireless, power, and telecommunications infrastructure on schedule for warehouse go-live.

American Signature Inc • Lead Network Engineer • October 2022 – April 2026

- Fortigate Firewall SD-WAN: Partnered with Masergy to design and support enterprise-wide network consisting of 140 remote sites; Supported firewall policies, BGP, OSPF, routing tables, security logs, QoS, circuits and failover configurations.
- Cloud-Managed Infrastructure: Installed and supported full-stack LAN deployment of Cisco Meraki solutions (MX, Z3, MS/MR series).
- Core & Distribution Switch Upgrades: Collaborated with team to upgrade enterprise core equipment, migrating legacy Cisco Catalyst 4500 platforms to Catalyst 9500 series executing high-availability configurations across SFPs, copper, and fiber uplinks.
- Data Center Migration: Managed migration of primary and backup data center networking from Cisco ACI spine-leaf topologies to Cisco Nexus platforms utilizing VPCs.
- WAN Modernization (MPLS to SD-WAN): Orchestrated the migration of the corporate datacenter from legacy Lumen MPLS to Masergy MPLS to facilitate the transition to a Masergy-managed SD-WAN environment then later upgraded the MPLS circuit from 50 mbps to 500 mbps.
- Hybrid-Cloud Connectivity: Collaborated with the SD-WAN provider to design, configure, and deploy cloud onramps for GCP by creating high-availability (HA) VPN tunnels between the on-

premises SD-WAN environment and Google Cloud Platform (GCP). Additionally, managed the network pathing, ExpressRoute and troubleshooting for Azure Active Directory authentication traffic, ensuring seamless user access to cloud-based applications and SSO-dependent services.

OhioHealth • Senior Desktop Administrator • March 2018 – October 2022

- Infrastructure Project Leadership: Directed the planning and implementation of IT infrastructure for 40+ enterprise projects, including network acquisitions and clinical renovations across the OhioHealth network.
- Tier 3 Network Escalation: Served as the final escalation point for complex enterprise connectivity issues, resolving critical outages for IP phones, mobile devices, and workstations.
- Advanced Diagnostics (Splunk & Fluke): Utilized Splunk to analyze logs and diagnose systemic issues, while performing physical layer testing with Fluke testers to validate patch panel terminations and switch configurations.
- Layer 2 Connectivity (FortiNac) & Provisioning: Configured endpoint network connectivity by managing switchport settings, creating FortiNac (Network Access Control) entries, and utilizing Efficient IP (EIP) for static and DHCP assignments.
- Enterprise Security & Risk Mitigation: Conducted system-wide security vulnerability assessments using Tenable scans, developing and executing remediation plans to lower the enterprise risk profile.
- Unified Systems Administration: Leveraged Microsoft Azure, Active Directory, and SCCM to manage enterprise operations, including Windows/Epic print servers and VDI disruptions.

OhioHealth • Desktop Support Technician • May 2015 - March 2018

- Network Troubleshooting: Diagnosed connectivity issues using Fluke testers, reviewed switch configurations, and managed NAC and Efficient IP (EIP) settings.
- Tier 2 Technical Support: Provided on-site support for an enterprise environment, resolving complex hardware/software issues for mobile and desktop devices.
- Technical Mentorship: Led onboarding and training for new Tier 2 technicians.

OhioHealth • Device Deployment Team & IT Help Desk • August 2014 - May 2015

- Hardware Refresh: Executed high-volume hardware refreshes, upgrading 30+ PCs per week and managing Tier 1 technical escalations.
- Imaging: Utilized SCCM, NAC, and VMware to deploy standardized images and configure network settings.

Dish Network • Advanced I.T. Support Supervisor • August 2012 - August 2014

- Team Leadership: Directed a team of 20 technicians, providing technical oversight for escalated networking, router, and cabling issues.

SEIU District 1199 • IT Support • March 2012 – August 2012

- Network Implementation: Managed desktop and network support for a 50-member staff, including the installation of wireless access points and backup servers.

Education

Western Governors University • Bachelor of Science in Network Operations and Security • May 2022
Columbus State College • Associate of Applied Science in Network Administration • June 2011

Certifications

- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA)
- AWS Certified SysOps Administrator
- CompTIA Network+, Security+, Cloud Essentials, A+, Project+
- Linux Essentials
- ITIL Foundations
- CCNP ENCOR – Candidate (Expected July 2026)